

Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. Resilience is built before a crisis becomes visible.
2. Good communication makes authority more accountable.
3. A society that cannot correct error cannot preserve knowledge.
4. Shared spaces teach the practical meaning of equality.

Marking guidance: Marking rubric: relevance and qualified thesis 20; organisation 20; analysis, examples and balance 25; grammar and vocabulary 25; conclusion and approximate 600-word limit 10.

Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

Preparedness is frequently judged by the existence of a plan. A document is necessary, but it cannot prove that people know their roles, equipment works or warnings reach those at risk. Real preparedness is a chain whose weakest link may determine the result. Forecasting is of little value if the message is delayed; a timely warning fails if it is not understood; an evacuation order fails when transport, shelters or trust are absent. Exercises expose these gaps before an emergency, provided they test realistic pressure rather than demonstrate a prearranged success. Local knowledge is equally important because residents know which road floods first, who needs assistance and which message will be trusted. Central coordination can supply standards and resources, but it should not silence local information. After an event, review must identify system failures without becoming a search for a convenient individual to blame. Preparedness improves when institutions convert experience into revised procedures, budgets, training and public communication.

1. Why is the existence of a plan insufficient evidence of preparedness?

Model answer: A plan does not show that roles are understood, equipment functions or warnings and assistance will reach people.

2. Explain the chain character of preparedness.

Model answer: Forecasting, communication, understanding, evacuation, transport, shelter and trust are linked; failure at one stage can defeat the rest.

3. What makes an exercise useful?

Model answer: It must reproduce realistic pressure and reveal gaps rather than stage a predetermined success.

4. How should central coordination and local knowledge relate?

Model answer: Central authorities should provide standards and resources while incorporating local knowledge about risks, people and trusted communication.

5. What is the purpose of post-event review?

Model answer: To identify systemic weaknesses and convert experience into improved procedures, budgets, training and communication.

Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Correction is often experienced as embarrassment because it admits that an earlier judgment was incomplete or wrong. Institutions may therefore defend a decision long after evidence has changed. This protects short-term reputation but increases long-term damage. A correction system should distinguish honest revision from negligence. People should be accountable for ignoring available evidence, concealing mistakes or repeating avoidable errors; they should not be punished merely for revising a reasonable conclusion when new facts emerge. Records make this distinction possible by showing what was known, why a choice was made and when contrary evidence appeared. Correction also requires communication. Quietly changing a rule may stop future harm but leaves affected people without remedy and allows false information to persist. A responsible institution states what changed, repairs consequences where possible and explains how recurrence will be prevented. The

capacity to correct is thus not evidence of weakness. It is a discipline that preserves trust by making authority answerable to reality.

Model answer: Institutions often resist correction to protect reputation, thereby increasing harm. Accountability should punish concealment, negligence and repeated avoidable error, not reasonable revision after new evidence. Records reveal what was known and when change became necessary. Responsible correction also informs affected people, repairs consequences and prevents recurrence. Revision is therefore a disciplined form of authority's accountability to reality.

Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

A. Correct the sentences

1. The quality of these roads have improved.

Answer: The quality of these roads has improved.

2. He ordered for a fresh inquiry.

Answer: He ordered a fresh inquiry.

3. She did not knew the rule.

Answer: She did not know the rule.

4. The equipment were tested.

Answer: The equipment was tested.

5. No sooner did he arrive when it rained.

Answer: No sooner did he arrive than it rained.

B. Supply the missing preposition or word

1. adhere ____

Answer: to

2. entrust ____

Answer: with

3. protect ____

Answer: from

4. depend ____

Answer: on

5. object ____

Answer: to

C. Use the correct verb form

1. By tomorrow, I ____ (finish) the draft.

Answer: will have finished

2. Unless he ____ (apologise), they will leave.

Answer: apologises

3. The bridge ____ (repair) last year.

Answer: was repaired

4. She ____ (write) when the lights failed.

Answer: was writing

5. We ____ (know) them for a decade.

Answer: have known

D. Choose the correct word

1. adapt/adopt

Answer: adopt

2. precede/proceed

Answer: precede

3. personal/personnel

Answer: personnel

4. cite/site

Answer: cite

5. eminent/imminent

Answer: imminent

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS